

Surface-Grinder — Standard Operating Procedure

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Surface-Grinder — Standard Operating Procedure

Audience: Maintenance Tech · Line Manager · Quality Worker
Applies to: Line-A, station 3, Surface-Grinder

1. Purpose

The Surface-Grinder is station 3 of Line-A. It removes the last few hundredths of a millimetre from the milled shaft to bring critical bearing surfaces into final tolerance before deburring and CMM inspection.

2. Normal operating envelope

- Ideal cycle time: **35 s**
- Max acceptable cycle time: **42 s**
- Expected reject rate: **≤ 2 %**
- Fault probability per cycle: **0.3 %**
- Input buffer capacity: **5 parts**

3. Idle reasons

idle_reason	Meaning on the Surface-Grinder	First check
Starved	CNC-Mill (station 2) is not feeding parts.	Verify mill state.
Blocked	Deburring-Station (station 4) cannot accept the part.	Verify deburring state.

4. Faults & corrective actions

4.1 Wheel-Wear

- **Symptoms in telemetry:** fault_type = "Wheel-Wear"; surface-finish rejects rise at CMM-Inspection in the preceding cycles.
- **Likely root cause:** grinding wheel diameter has fallen below the minimum usable size or has glazed.

- **Corrective action:**
 1. LOTO. Measure wheel diameter; replace if below the manufacturer's minimum.
 2. Dress the wheel using the diamond dresser; record new size.
 3. Re-zero the wheel head offset against the master.
- **Restart criteria:** surface roughness $Ra \leq 0.4 \mu m$ on three test parts.

4.2 Coolant-Clog

- **Symptoms in telemetry:** `fault_type = "Coolant-Clog"`. May follow a period of elevated grinding sparks reported by the operator.
- **Likely root cause:** swarf and grinding sludge have plugged the coolant delivery line or the through-spindle filter.
- **Corrective action:**
 1. LOTO. Drain and flush the coolant manifold.
 2. Replace the inline filter cartridge.
 3. Verify coolant pressure at the wheel ≥ 30 psi.
- **Restart criteria:** stable coolant pressure with no sparks at first contact.

4.3 Alignment-Drift

- **Symptoms in telemetry:** `fault_type = "Alignment-Drift"`. CMM begins flagging parallelism or perpendicularity rejects shortly before the fault.
- **Likely root cause:** column lock-up shifted; thermal growth from a long uninterrupted run.
- **Corrective action:**
 1. LOTO. Let the grinder cool for 15 minutes.
 2. Re-square the wheel head to the table with a master square.
 3. Run a one-pass test on a calibration block.
- **Restart criteria:** test block within ± 0.005 mm of nominal.

5. Preventive maintenance schedule

- **Daily:** check coolant level and pressure.
- **Weekly:** wheel dress; clean magnetic chuck.
- **Monthly:** column lubricant level; replace coolant filter.
- **Quarterly:** table alignment check; bearing greasing.

6. References

- Maintenance_Workflow_Overview.pdf
- Safety_Lockout_Tagout_Procedure.pdf
- Line-A_02_CNC-Mill_SOP.pdf
- Line-A_04_Deburring-Station_SOP.pdf
- Line-A_05_CMM-Inspection_Calibration.pdf